Engineering assignment: Standup action tracker

What this is about

Most engineering teams have a short meeting every morning where each person says what they're working on, what's blocked, and what's changed. Someone is supposed to write down the action items afterward.

Build something that takes in the standup transcript and converts it into a running list of action items. You can think of it as an agent that updates Linear or Jira based on the standup discussion.

What to build

1. Turn standups into a running list of action items

Below are five standup transcripts, Monday to Friday. Process them in order.

The list carries over from one day to the next. Today's standup can add items, update them, close them, reassign them, or change their dates.

For each item, show:

- What it is.
- Who owns it, if known.
- When it's due, if a date was given.
- Its current status.
- The words in the transcript that support it.

The conversations contain uncertainty and incomplete information. Decide how your system should handle that, and explain the important choices.

Your system should accept transcript text and its date. A text box, file input, or command-line entry is fine. It should also work with a new transcript beyond these five examples.

2. A page the lead checks after each standup

The lead was in the meeting and wants to quickly check what the system captured.

The page should show what changed today. The lead should be able to:

- Fix an owner or a date.
- Remove an item.
- Approve the result.

The reviewed list should carry forward into the next day.

3. A few meaningful tests

You'll most likely use an AI model to read the transcripts. Models make mistakes that normal code doesn't: they skip things, make things up, give an item to the wrong person, or treat Tuesday's mention of something as a brand-new item.

Write a few tests that check the things you think matter most. A simple script is fine. We care about which checks you picked and what they demonstrate, not how many you wrote.

If your tests or demo use saved example AI responses, say so. Separately tell us what you tested by sending transcripts to a real AI model.

Scope and time

Spend **3–5 hours** on this. If you reach five hours, stop and send what you have.

We'd rather see something unfinished with good decisions than something finished at 2 a.m. Tell us roughly how long you spent and what remains unfinished.

Use a coding agent to help you build this. You can choose any language, framework, and coding agent.

You don't need login, a database, deployment, or integrations with Linear or other services. Keeping state in memory or a local file is fine.

Make it possible for us to run the app and tests locally. If it needs a model API key, explain how to supply one without including your key in the submission.

The team

Arjun is the lead. Priya, Dev (Devansh), and Sana are engineers.

Hermes is the team's notifications service. Atlas is the internal admin dashboard.

Tickets are in Linear: PAY- is payments, APP- is the main app.

The five standups

These are written the way people actually talk in a standup.

Monday, 13 October 2025

Arjun: Okay, let's go, I've got a call at ten fifteen. I'll start. Search latency, still on it. I thought it was the query but I'm not sure anymore, I'll know by tonight. Should have a fix today, maybe tomorrow worst case. Priya?
Priya: Um, so the auth bug from yesterday, the one from the support ticket? I can pick that up. I mean, actually, Dev, you were in that code last week for the refresh thing, right? Do you want it?
Dev: Yeah, I had context. I'll take it. Pretty sure it's the token refresh, same area.
Arjun: Cool, Dev on auth then. Sana?
Sana: So, the Hermes staging deploy is blocked. The cert expired over the weekend, I only found out when the deploy failed this morning. It's with infra, I've pinged them in the channel, no reply yet.
Arjun: Right, that's not ours then. Just keep on them. Anything else?
Sana: No, that's it for me. Oh, actually, one thing. Should we do something about the flaky test in CI? It failed twice yesterday, and both times it was the same timeout.
Arjun: Hmm. Let's talk about it after, not now. Priya, since you're off auth?
Priya: Yeah, so I'm free now. I'll start on the export feature. We said Friday for that, but honestly with the auth thing moving around and me losing this morning to it, Monday is more realistic.
Arjun: Fine, Monday. Dev, anything else?
Dev: Oh, the customer who emailed about the CSV thing, the encoding issue, I replied last night, that's done. Nothing else.
Priya: One more from me, sorry. The onboarding doc is out of date. I noticed when support asked for it, half the links are dead.

Arjun: Noted. Someone should fix that at some point. Okay, that's it, go.

Tuesday, 14 October 2025

Arjun: Quick one today. Search, still on it. Turns out it's the index, not the query, so the fix is a bit bigger than I thought. Tomorrow, probably.
Dev: PAY-231, the auth one. Confirmed it's token refresh, fix is going out today, I just need Priya to glance at the PR. Also, someone pinged me about the Atlas login being slow. Might be related to 231, might not. I'll look after.
Arjun: Okay.
Sana: Infra got back. They say the cert will be done tomorrow morning. Nothing else from me.
Priya: Export's going fine. Still Monday. I'll look at Dev's PR after this.
Arjun: Good. That's it.

Wednesday, 15 October 2025

Arjun: Morning. Search fix is in review, finally. Dev, can you look at it today? It's not big, two files.
Dev: Yeah, I'll review Arjun's search PR today. Auth is done, by the way, deployed last night, Priya looked at it. The Atlas login thing was unrelated, it was just a slow query on the roles table, I fixed it while I was in there.
Arjun: Nice.
Sana: Cert's in. Hermes staging deploy went out this morning, all green. All good.
Arjun: Great. Also, heads up, Falcon kickoff is Thursday, two pm. Priya and Dev, block the afternoon.
Priya: Okay. Is there a doc or anything?
Arjun: I'll send something tonight.
Priya: Cool. The Atlas export is still on for Monday.
Arjun: Good. That's it.

Thursday, 16 October 2025

Arjun: So, before we start, Rohan's starting today. Intern, final year, he's with us till December. He's sitting with Sana this week, so Sana, be nice. Say hi, Rohan.
Rohan: Hi everyone.
Dev: Hey. Okay, so, bad news, 231 is back. Different cause this time, it's the session cookie, not the refresh. Someone reported it last night. I'm on it, should be quick now that I know where to look. Oh, and the search PR, I reviewed it, left two comments, nothing big, Arjun you can just merge.
Arjun: Already did. Search is merged, I'm watching the numbers, so far so good. Falcon. For Rohan's benefit: Falcon is the payments DB migration, we're moving off the old schema. Priya and Dev are on it for the next two weeks. Dev, you're splitting with 231 until that's closed, then full time.
Dev: Yeah.
Priya: Yeah. Which means, um, export is going to slip. Falcon ate my week, basically, the kickoff alone was three hours. Say Wednesday?
Arjun: Wednesday's fine.
Sana: I'm picking up the Hermes retry bug, APP-402, the one where it retries forever on a 400. Should be done tomorrow, it's small.
Rohan: Um, I can take the onboarding doc, if that's still a thing? I was going to read it anyway, so I'll notice what's wrong.
Arjun: It's still a thing. Yes, take it. Good. Okay, that's it.

Friday, 17 October 2025

Arjun: Sana's out sick, she messaged this morning, so anything of hers rolls to Monday. Dev?
Dev: Auth is fixed, for real this time. Monitored overnight, clean, no reports. I'm done with 231 unless it comes back a third time.
Arjun: Good. We should do a retro on that one next week, it bounced twice, I want to know why we missed the cookie thing the first time.
Priya: Falcon schema draft is up, I put it in the channel. Dev's reviewing.
Dev: Yeah, today, after lunch.
Rohan: Onboarding doc, I've got a draft, I'll send it to Priya to check, since she flagged it.
Priya: Sure.
Arjun: Okay. That's it. Have a good weekend. Don't deploy on Friday.

What we're looking at

We're interested in:

- Whether the system captures useful action items and carries them through the week.
- Whether the lead can understand and correct the proposed changes quickly.
- The choices you made when the conversation was unclear.
- How you checked that the system works.
- What you deliberately left out to fit the time limit.

There isn't one required framework, architecture, or exact number of action items. Be ready to explain your choices.

In the follow-up interviews, we'll discuss the product decisions and how the system works. We may also give you a short new transcript or ask you to walk through a small change.

Before you start

Create a new folder called `halos-assignment`. Run `git init` before your first coding-agent prompt.

Commit at meaningful points as you work. Don't squash or rewrite the history before submitting.

Keep your coding-agent conversation transcript for this assignment. Check early that your tool can save or export it. If that isn't possible, contact us so we can agree on an alternative.

We only want sessions related to this assignment. Don't send your entire agent history. You may redact credentials, personal information, or unrelated content; briefly note any redactions.

What to send

Email your submission to **naman@haloshq.com** with:

1. **A link to your public repository.** Keep the commit history. We should be able to access it without an invitation.
2. **A README in the repository** covering:
   - How to run the app and tests.
   - Your important choices and why you made them.
   - What you ran to verify it, the results, and anything you couldn't verify.
   - What you left out or didn't finish.
   - What you would do with one more day.
   - Roughly how long you spent.

3. **Your coding-agent transcript**, attached to the email as an export or archive containing only this assignment's sessions. It doesn't need to be published in the repository.

Please don't include API keys or other secrets in the repository or transcript.